PLAIN-ENGLISH OPERATIONS GUIDE

Managing Booking.com & Airbnb Directly Without Beds24

Why Beds24 is optional, how our website bookings already work on their own, and how we can connect Airbnb and Booking.com directly to BokoBoko and our partner ERP.

1. WHY BEDS24 IS OPTIONAL
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What is already 100% ours vs OTA sync

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Two-way iCal + Email/CSV parser

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Why Do We Have Beds24, and Can We Drop It?

Beds24 is just a calendar switchboard. We do NOT need it to take website bookings, and we CAN connect to Airbnb & Booking.com directly.

1. Website Bookings

Already 100% Independent

- Guests book on book.bokoboko.org.
- Saved directly in our own Supabase database (booking_intents).
- Paid via Paystack or manual bank/MoMo transfer.
- Confirmation emails sent directly via Resend.
- Needs zero third-party channel manager.

2. Airbnb & Booking.com

Why Calendar Sync Matters

- If someone books "Patience" on Airbnb for Dec 10-12, Booking.com and our Website must block Dec 10-12.
- Today, Beds24 relays that block.
- Without Beds24, our own app can exchange iCal (.ics) calendar links directly with Airbnb & Booking.com for free.

3. Why Not Direct APIs?

The Industry Catch

- Airbnb & Booking.com lock their real-time APIs behind "PMS Partner" certification programs.
- They rarely grant direct API keys to a single resort.
- However, BOTH platforms give every host free, built-in iCal calendar import/export links.

How to Manage Airbnb & Booking.com Directly

We make our own Supabase / ERP database the master calendar and connect Airbnb & Booking.com with two simple mechanisms:

Mechanism A: Two-Way iCal Calendar Sync

Prevents double bookings across all channels ($0/month)

- Outbound (.ics export): BokoBoko publishes 7 calendar URLs (one per room, e.g. /api/ical/691857.ics). Paste them into Airbnb & Booking.com "Import Calendar".
- Inbound (.ics import): Copy each room's "Export Calendar" link from Airbnb & Booking.com into BokoBoko.
- Our server checks those links every 10-15 minutes and blocks booked dates automatically.

Mechanism B: OTA Price & Guest Data into ERP

Fills in guest name & payout amount for ERP reports

- Why needed: iCal links only share blocked dates, not the payout price or guest email.
- Automated option: Auto-forward Airbnb & Booking.com confirmation emails to an inbound webhook that parses guest name, room, dates, and payout into the ERP.
- Simple option: Upload the monthly earnings CSV from Airbnb & Booking.com into the ERP.

DIRECT DATA FLOW (ZERO BEDS24):

```
Airbnb & Booking.com   <--[ Two-Way .ics Links + Email/CSV Parser ]-->   BokoBoko DB & Partner ERP
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Comparison & 3-Step Cutover Plan

How keeping Beds24 compares to running directly via iCal + Email/CSV.

CRITERIA	KEEP BEDS24 (CURRENT)	DIRECT ICAL + EMAIL/CSV (NO BEDS24)
Monthly Fee & Sync Speed	Small monthly fee | Instant sync	**$0 / month | Syncs every 15-30 min**
Double-Booking Risk	Virtually zero	**Low (only if 2 guests book within ~15 min)**
Where Room Prices Are Edited	One place	**In Website, Airbnb & Booking.com separately**
Guest & Revenue Data in ERP	Automatic via API	**Automatic via email parser or CSV import**
Engineering Time to Launch	0 days (already live)	**3 - 5 days of build work**

Step 1: Master Calendar in Supabase/ERP

Store direct bookings & date blocks locally first.

Step 2: Build iCal + Email/CSV Feed (3-5d)

Add 7 room .ics links + 15-min poller + OTA parser.

Step 3: Link OTAs & Cancel Beds24

Paste .ics URLs into Airbnb & Booking.com, then turn off Beds24.